



2026-2027 PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAM

TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE PACKET



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ENSURE THAT ALL SCHOLARS
ARE EDUCATED, SELF-DIRECTED,
AND PRODUCTIVE MEMBERS
OF SOCIETY.

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PRIVATE SCHOOL FEDERAL GRANT PARTICIPATION TIME LINES

DATE	TASK
November 13, 2026	• 2027-28 Election to Participate forms due to GRPS • Title IIA enrolled counts by grade level • Title IA student data updates & new student registration forms are due to GRPS Assessment & Evaluation (A&E)
November 13, 2026	• Identification of student currently receiving Title IA and Title IVA services & their pretest scores. (GRPS/A&E)
March 26, 2026 2:00PM - 3:30PM	• Introduction of GRPS staff • Overview of federal programs • Participation process
Last week of March 2026	• Preliminary allocations will be distributed for participating schools
April 2026	• Work session • Please email Marissa Stoutjesdyk for appointment
April 2026	• Make-up work session • Please email Marissa Stoutjesdyk for appointment
May 9, 2026	• Preliminary Title IA and Title IVA budget plans due to GRPS • Preliminary Title IIA Professional Development Plan due to GRPS • Needs Assessment forms due to GRPS • Preliminary out of state travel requests due to GRPS
May 2026	Title IIA Individual Consultation Meetings (as needed)
June 3, 2027	• Post-test scores due to A&E • Final Title IIA Professional Development Plans due to GRPS
October 2026 (Tentative; dependent on MDE)	Final allocations distributed to participating schools
November 2026	Adjusted budget plans, if necessary, due to GRPS

EVERY STUDENT SUCCEEDS ACT (ESSA) PROVISIONS

General Information for Districts to Establish Private School Programs Under the Provisions: Title I, Part A; Title I, Part C; Title II, Part A; Title III (EL) and Title IV, Part A

The Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) was signed by President Obama in December 2015. This bipartisan measure reauthorizes the 50-year-old Elementary and Secondary Education Act (ESEA), the nation's national education law and longstanding commitment to equal opportunity for all students.

The new law builds on key areas of progress in recent years, made possible by the efforts of educators, communities, parents, and students across the country.

The previous version of the law, the No Child Left Behind (NCLB) Act, was enacted in 2002. NCLB represented a significant step forward for our nation's children in many respects, particularly as it shined a light on where students were making progress and where they needed additional support, regardless of race, income, zip code, disability, home language, or background. The law was scheduled for revision in 2007, and, over time, NCLB's prescriptive requirements became increasingly unworkable for schools and educators. Recognizing this fact, in 2010, the Obama administration joined a call from educators and families to create a better law that focused on the clear goal of fully preparing all students for success in college and careers.

Since the passage of ESEA in 1965, local educational agencies (LEAs) have been required to provide equitable educational services to eligible private school students, teachers, parents and other personnel. Equitable services applies to all Federal programs not just Title I. Private schools receive no direct funds from these programs. Program funds are granted to the public authorities, usually a local education agency, that is in turn responsible for serving eligible students, teachers, parents, and other personnel, whether they attend public or private school. The formula, requirements, and procedures vary by program, but the principle of the public authority's responsibility for all eligible students within its jurisdiction remain constant.

GENERAL REQUIREMENTS

ESSA defines private schools to be only private nonprofit schools. In previous reauthorizations, these schools were referred to as "private" schools or "private nonprofit" schools.

NOTIFY ANNUALLY, IN WRITING, ALL PRIVATE SCHOOLS OF AVAILABLE SERVICES

- Specify criteria for participation, needed demographic information and due date.

JOINT PLANNING/CONSULTATION

- Consultation involves the initial contact with enough flexible scheduling opportunities to ensure participation by representatives of the private schools.
- Private school administrators and other persons are provided adequate opportunity to participate in the planning of the services to be provided.
- The ultimate decision rests with the public school, based on the most effective use of funds.

EQUITY

- Educational services or other benefits for private school children shall be equitable in comparison to services and other benefits for public school children participating under this part, and shall be provided in a timely manner.

CHECKLIST CONSULTATION TOPICS

This list of consultation topics provides the LEA officials with the specific topics that must be covered in consultation meetings as required under Sec. 1117(b) of Title I and Sec. 200. 63 of the Title I regulations. The goal of all parties should be to reach an agreement on how to provide equitable and effective programs for eligible private school students, teachers, educational personnel and families. As LEA and private school officials address and complete discussions on each topic, **the LEA officials may want to check-off each item as finished** to create a record for future reference should the need arise.

DOCUMENTATION OF PRIVATE SCHOOL CONSULTATION

The following topics must be discussed during meaningful consultation with the private school with the goal of reaching agreement on how to provide equitable and effective programs for eligible private school students, teachers, educational personnel and families based on a Comprehensive Needs Assessment (CNA).

UNIFORM CONSULTATION TOPICS FOR GRANT SOURCES

TITLE I, PART A: Date Completed: _____ N/A: ☐

1. The source of data and method used to determine the number of students from low income families in participating attendance areas has been explained.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
2. The amount of funds available for Title I services and how the private school amount is calculated has been explained.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
3. The LEA and private school have identified the needs of eligible resident students.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
4. The services the LEA will provide to the private school have been agreed upon.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
5. When, where and by whom the services will be provided has been specified.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
6. How the services will be assessed and how the results of the assessment will be used to improve those services have been discussed.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
7. The size and scope of the services to be provided to the private school students and educational personnel have been determined.
 Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐
 Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Continued on next page

CHECKLIST CONSULTATION TOPICS

8. The LEA and private school have made decisions about the delivery of services. These decisions include a thorough consideration of the views of the private school officials on providing contract services through potential third-party providers, by pooling funds, or by consolidating funds from other Federal programs that are dedicated to providing equitable services to private school students.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

TITLE II, PART A: Date Completed: _____ N/A: ☐

1. The Professional Development needs of staff have been determined and PD activities for staff have been agreed upon, if applicable.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

TITLE III, PART A: Date Completed: _____ N/A: ☐

1. The needs of eligible ELs have been identified and specific services have been agreed upon for students, if applicable.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

TITLE IV, PART A: Date Completed: _____ N/A: ☐

1. The needs of the private school have been determined for these funds, if applicable.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

AFFIRMATIONS OF MEANINGFUL CONSULTATION

1. Timely and meaningful consultation has occurred and the LEA has considered the comments of the private school officials before decisions were made that affected the participation of eligible private school students, teachers, educational personnel and families.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

2. The services to be provided to meet the needs of eligible private school students have been agreed upon.

Initial: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

Amendment: LEA Yes ☐ No ☐ N/A ☐ Private: Yes ☐ No ☐

If you have answered "No" to any of the above items, please identify the item number(s), the person responding, indicate LEA or private school, and provide a brief explanation for your response(s).

If LEA disagrees with the views of the private school officials with respect to any of the issues described above, the LEA will provide the private school officials with a written explanation as to the reason for the disagreement.

If the private school officials do not agree that the above conditions have been met, they are encouraged to provide a written statement to the LEA specifying the reasons for their disagreement.

If an agreement cannot be settled upon, please see the Complaint Process for Private Schools on the Equitable Services Ombudsman website at www.michigan.gov/mde-esombudsman.

The completed Documentation of Private School Consultation Form with any attachments shall be maintained by the LEA, and a copy shall be transmitted via GEMS/ MARS, to the State's Equitable Services Ombudsman who oversees and monitors equitable services for private school students.

Initial Consultation:

LEA School Official _____ Date _____

Private School Official _____ Date _____

LEA Name _____

Private School Name _____

Amendment Consultation:

LEA Official _____ Date _____

Private School Official _____ Date _____

LEA Name _____

Private School Name _____

FEDERAL PROGRAMS PRIVATE SCHOOL ALLOCATION METHODOLOGIES

TITLE I, PART A

1. For each private school site, determine the number of free and reduced lunch-eligible students at the site who reside within the GRPS attendance area.
2. Determine a per-pupil amount by dividing the preliminary 2026-2027 allocation by the sum of all GRPS and private school free and reduced lunch eligible students residing in the GRPS attendance area.
3. Allocate the per-pupil amount to the number of free and reduced lunch eligible students at each private school site.

TITLE II, PART A

1. Develop a per-pupil allocation by dividing the 2026-2027 preliminary allocation by the sum of all GRPS and private school enrollments.
2. Allocate the per-pupil amount to the number of students enrolled at each private school site.

TITLE III

1. Determine the number of eligible EL identified by the World-Class Instructional Design and Assessment (WIDA ACCESS) or WIDA SCREENER in GRPS and each participating private school.
2. Determine a per-pupil allocation by dividing the preliminary 2026-2027 allocation by the sum of all GRPS and participating private school EL eligible students.
3. Allocate the per-pupil amount to the number of EL eligible students at each participating private school.

TITLE IV, PART A

1. Develop a per-pupil allocation by dividing the 2026-2027 preliminary allocation by the sum of all GRPS and private school enrollments.
2. Allocate the per-pupil amount to the number of students enrolled at each private school site.

PRIVATE SCHOOL TITLE 1 DATA COLLECTION TASKS

DATA COLLECTION TASK	WHO'S RESPONSIBLE	2025-26 DUE DATE	TENTATIVE 2026-27 DUE DATE
Prepare the data and forms including Private School Student Master Listing (password-protected) and PS Title I Student Registration Form .	GRPS Assessment & Evaluation (A&E) - Addie Collins - Heidi Talaga	October 17, 2025	October 16, 2026
Email initial information (including password-protected file) to private school principal (or designee).	GRPS Assessment & Evaluation (A&E) - Addie Collins - Heidi Talaga	October 27, 2025	October 26, 2026
Review and update student eligibility records including the Private School Student Master Listing and PS Title I Student Registration Form (registration form is necessary for students not included on the Master Listing only); return to A&E.	Private school principal (Or Designee)	November 14, 2025	November 13, 2026
Complete PS Title I Instructional Services and/or PS Title I Support Services forms indicating the students who are receiving Title I services for the current school year; include pre-test scores (either previous Spring scores or current Fall scores); return to A&E.	Private school principal (Or Designee)	November 14, 2025	November 13, 2026
Provide private school staff with a revised Private School Student Master Listing for the current school year based upon their edits.	GRPS Assessment & Evaluation (A&E) - Addie Collins - Heidi Talaga	Spring 2026	Spring 2027
Using the completed PS Title I Instructional Services and/or PS Title I Support Services forms from December, indicate each student's post-test score (current Spring scores) and return to A&E.	Private school principal (Or Designee)	June 6, 2026	June 3, 2027

DIRECTIONS FOR USING THE PRIVATE SCHOOL SUPPLEMENTAL HOUSEHOLD FAMILY INCOME FORM

Private schools are eligible to receive federal funding to provide supplemental instruction for students who are economically disadvantaged or at risk of failing to meet state standards. Allocation of these federal funds are calculated based on the percentage of students from low-income families who reside within the Grand Rapids Public Schools boundaries.

Previously, this information was determined based upon the number of students who qualified for free and reduced lunch at school

For private schools to be eligible for federal funding to support supplemental instruction, they will need to collect this additional information from their families. The form labeled “Private School

Supplemental Household Family Income Form” (see next page) is a template for you to create a form specific to your school. Feel free to make edits to the body of the letter to parents. However, the questions included in the form should remain as is.

NOTES:

1. You will need to identify the staff person who will be responsible for collecting this form (see **[insert staff person’s name]** in template) and maintaining confidentiality and protecting the data families share. For many schools, this person may be the principal or a designee.
2. You will also need to indicate a due date (see **[insert due date]** in template). Keep in mind, the November due dates for the Title I data collection process. Give yourself sufficient time to conduct follow-up on unreturned forms, if needed.
3. These forms are **NOT** submitted to GRPS. Private schools are responsible for protecting the completed Private School Supplemental Household Family Income Forms and keeping this information secure. In the event of an audit, private schools will need to maintain these documents for up to three (3) years.
4. You will then use this family income information to determine those students who meet the income criteria for free or reduced lunch eligibility.

PRIVATE SCHOOL SUPPLEMENTAL HOUSEHOLD FAMILY INCOME FORM

Dear Parent/Guardian:

Private schools are eligible to receive federal funding to provide supplemental instruction for students who are economically disadvantaged or at risk of failing to meet state standards. Allocation of these federal funds are calculated based on the percentage of students from low-income families who reside within the Grand Rapids Public Schools boundaries.

Previously, this information was determined based upon the number of students who qualified for free and reduced lunch at school.

For our school to be eligible for federal funding to support supplemental instruction, families will need to complete the questions below and return this form to **[insert staff person's name]** by no later than **[insert due date]**. **Your responses will remain confidential and protected.**

Indicate the name of your child(ren):

FIRST NAME	LAST NAME

Does your child or anyone in the home receive the following benefits:

BENEFIT	YES	NO
Food Stamps Supplemental Nutritional Assistance Program (SNAP)?		
Temporary Cash Assistance for Needy Families?		
Food Distribution Program on Indian Reservations (FDPIR)?		

Indicate the total number of people (adults + children) who live in your household:	
Indicate the combined total household monthly income:	\$

Name of the person completing this form:	
Signature:	
Date:	

INCOME GUIDELINES FREE LUNCH

SCALE A. FREE MEALS OR FREE PM KINDERGARTEN MILK

*New guidelines will be distributed in July 2026.

TOTAL FAMILY SIZE	ANNUAL	MONTHLY	TWICE PER MONTH	EVERY TWO WEEKS	WEEKLY
1	\$20,345	\$1,696	\$848	\$783	\$392
2	\$27,495	\$2,292	\$1,146	\$1,058	\$529
3	\$34,645	\$2,888	\$1,444	\$1,333	\$667
4	\$41,795	\$3,483	\$1,742	\$1,608	\$804
5	\$48,945	\$4,079	\$2,040	\$1,883	\$942
6	\$56,095	\$4,675	\$2,338	\$2,158	\$1,079
7	\$63,245	\$5,271	\$2,636	\$2,433	\$1,217
8	\$70,395	\$5,867	\$2,934	\$2,708	\$1,354
Each Additional Family Member	+\$7,150	+\$596	+\$298	+275	+138

SCALE B. SCALE FOR REDUCED PRICE MEALS

TOTAL FAMILY SIZE	ANNUAL	MONTHLY	TWICE PER MONTH	EVERY TWO WEEKS	WEEKLY
1	\$28,953	\$2,413	\$1,207	\$1,114	\$557
2	\$39,128	\$3,261	\$1,631	\$1,505	\$753
3	\$49,303	\$4,109	\$2,055	\$1,897	\$949
4	\$59,478	\$4,957	\$2,405	\$2,288	\$1,144
5	\$69,653	\$5,805	\$2,903	\$2,679	\$1,340
6	\$79,828	\$6,653	\$3,327	\$3,071	\$1,536
7	\$90,003	\$7,501	\$3,751	\$3,462	\$1,731
8	\$100,178	\$8,349	\$4,175	\$3,853	\$1,927
Each Additional Family Member	+\$10,175	+\$848	+\$424	+\$392	+\$196

INCOME TO REPORT

EARNINGS FROM WORK	PUBLIC ASSISTANCE/ALIMONY/CHILD SUPPORT	PENSIONS/RETIREMENT/ALL OTHER INCOME
- Salary, wages, cash bonuses, commission Net income from self employment (farm or business) - Strike benefits, unemployment compensation If you are in the U.S. Military: - Basic pay and cash bonuses (DO NOT include combat pay, FSSA or privatized housing allowances) - Allowances for off-base housing, food and clothing	- Unemployment benefits - Worker's compensation - Supplemental Security Income (SSI) - Cash assistance from State or local government - Alimony payments - Child support payments - Veteran's benefits - Pensions	- Social Security (including railroad retirement and black lung benefits) - Private Pensions or disability benefits - Income from trusts or estates - Annuities - Investment income - Earned interest - Net rental income - Regular cash payments from outside household - Adoption assistance payments

2026-2027 GUIDELINES FOR SPENDING OF FEDERAL FUNDS BY PRIVATE SCHOOLS

Grand Rapids Public Schools (GRPS) is responsible for providing oversight and consultation in the spending of federal funds by private schools. The federal programs included in this responsibility are:

- **TITLE I, PART A – IMPROVING BASIC PROGRAMS**
- **TITLE II, PART A – TEACHER, PRINCIPAL PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT**
- **TITLE III – ENGLISH LEARNERS SERVICES**
- **TITLE IV, PART A – STUDENT SUPPORT AND ACADEMIC ENRICHMENT (SSAE)**
- **21ST CENTURY COMMUNITY LEARNING CENTERS**

Following is a list of guidelines that must be followed in order for GRPS to remain in compliance with the federal programs:

1. All expenditures must be incurred in the GRPS financial system.
At no time can GRPS make a reimbursement payment to a private school. GRPS must pay the respective vendor.
2. All expenditures must be allowable under the federal program for which the expenditure request is being made and must be in accordance with GRPS guidelines:
 - a. All reimbursement requests submitted must follow the GRPS guidelines which can be found under Appendix A. (e.g. original detailed receipts are required).
 - b. Mileage reimbursement must also follow GRPS guidelines which can be found under Appendix B (e.g. mileage reimbursement rate is the current irs.gov rate at the time of the travel – March 2026 this rate is 0.7250 cents/mile)
 - c. Meal allowances are also outlined in the GRPS guidelines and follow the allowable limits on gsa.gov (e.g. local Michigan rates are breakfast (\$20), lunch (\$22), and dinner (\$33))
3. In order for the GRPS to properly record and report expenditures to the funding agencies, dates for submission of purchasing documents have been developed. Adherence to these dates is required. **Any documents submitted beyond these dates may not be processed and will be returned.**
 - a. March 31: Out-of-state supplies/materials purchase requests.
 - b. March 31: In-state supplies/materials purchase requests.
 - c. July 7: Payment to consultants, conference requests.
 - d. September 30: Final expenditures are due for July through September Grant period.
4. **GRPS forms should be used when making a purchasing/ payment request.** These forms are available upon request. Please refer to the GRPS Federal Programs Contact List. Below is a list of forms and their appropriate use. Please indicate the funding source on the completed form and return to the appropriate GRPS Federal programs contact.
 - a. Purchase Request Form: Purchase supplies and materials and pay vendors for the cost of conferences.
 - b. Payment Request Form: Pay training consultants, and reimburse staff for conference expenses.

SUMMARY OF ALLOWABLE PRIVATE SCHOOL USES OF FUNDS BY FEDERAL GRANTS

USE	TITLE I PART A	TITLE I PART C	TITLE II PART A	TITLE III PART A
Salaries for private school staff	No	No	No	No
Salaries of district staff who service private schools	Yes	Yes	Yes, if providing professional development outside of contracted hours	Yes
Substitutes for ANY reason	No	No	No	No
Stipends for private school staff - Professional development in core academic areas (Secular content only) - Reasonable & necessary - Outside of school day - Paid directly to teacher by district	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Purchase of computers	Yes, if exclusively for use by Title I students	Yes, if exclusively for use by Migrant students	No	Yes, if exclusively for by EL students
Supplies	Yes, for Title I students	Yes, for Migrant students	Yes, for PD	Yes, for EL students
Class size reduction	No	No	No	No
Support for private school staff to become Highly Qualified (HQ)	No	No	No	Yes, only for HQ ESL/Bilingual
Professional development	Yes, for assisting Title I students	Yes, for assisting Migrant students	Yes	Yes, for assisting EL students

TITLE I

ALLOWABLE PROGRAM EXPENDITURES

Title I funds are expended to implement academic research-based programs that help students improve their academic achievement in the regular private school classrooms (i.e., reading, mathematics, ELA, etc). **Title I program expenditures can include the following:**

1. Salaries and fringe benefits for highly qualified teachers directly staffed by the LEA
2. Salaries and fringe benefits for qualified tutors directly staffed by the LEA
3. Books, materials, and equipment necessary to implement the Title I program. (The LEA retains title to the books, other materials, and equipment purchased with Title I funds). Materials, etc. purchased with Title I funds may be used only by Title I participants. Each item purchased with Title I funds must be properly labeled
4. Extended-day services
5. Summer programs
6. Saturday programs
7. Counseling programs
8. Take-home computers (the LEA should ensure that families and students are properly trained in computer and software use)
9. Computer-assisted instruction

LOCATION OF SERVICES AND EQUIPMENT

1. Title I services must be provided in a separate space that is under the LEA's control when Title I services are being provided.
2. If the services are provided in a library or private school classroom, the space must be separate and partitioned off.
3. Computer equipment and other supplies purchased with Title I funds may be used only by Title I students in the Title I program.

2027-2028 ELECTION TO PARTICIPATE WITHIN BOUNDARY SCHOOLS

PLEASE RETURN COMPLETED FORM NO LATER THAN NOVEMBER 13, 2026.

School Name

☐ **YES.** Our school is electing to participate in the following federal program(s) for the 2027-2028 school year.

Please check all that apply. Unchecked items indicate that you will not be participating in that program during the 2027-2028 school year.

- ☐ **Title I, Part A – Improving Basic Programs**
- ☐ **Title II, Part A – Improving Teacher Quality**
- ☐ **Title III – English Learners Services**
- ☐ **Title IV, Part A – Student Support & Academic Enrichment (SSAE)**
- ☐ **21st Century Community Learning Center**

☐ **NO.** Our school does not wish to participate in federal programming during 2027-2028.

School Contact Name

Title

Phone Number

Email Address

Signature

Date

**PLEASE RETURN
NO LATER THAN
NOV. 13, 2026 TO:**
Grand Rapids
Public Schools
Attn: Addie Collins
1331 Martin Luther
King Jr. St.
Grand Rapids, MI
49506-2634

2027-2028 ELECTION TO PARTICIPATE OUT OF BOUNDARY SCHOOLS

PLEASE RETURN COMPLETED FORM NO LATER THAN NOVEMBER 13, 2026.

School Name

☐ **YES.** Our school is electing to participate in the following federal program(s) for the 2027-2028 school year.

Please check all that apply. Unchecked items indicate that you will not be participating in that program during the 2027-2028 school year.

☐ **Title I, Part A – Improving Basic Programs**

The following programs are NOT applicable: Please see your local school district.

- Title II, Part A – Improving Teacher Quality
- Title III – English Learners Services
- Title IV – Part A – Student Support & Academic Enrichment (SSAE)
- 21st Century Community Learning Center

☐ **NO.** Our school does not wish to participate in federal programming during 2027-2028.

**PLEASE RETURN
NO LATER THAN
NOV. 13, 2026 TO:**

Grand Rapids
Public Schools
Attn: Addie Collins
1331 Martin Luther
King Jr. St.
Grand Rapids, MI
49506-2634

School Contact Name

Title

Phone Number

Email Address

Signature

Date

AVERAGE POSITION COSTS

The following rates are for GRPS year 2026–2027. All rates include benefits and/or payroll taxes.

		Teacher	Counselor	Social Worker
		\$125,000	\$115,000	\$117,500
0. 10 fte	3 hours per week	\$12,500	\$11,500	\$11,750
0. 20 fte	6 hours per week	\$25,000	\$23,000	\$23,500
0. 30 fte	9 hours per week	\$37,500	\$34,500	\$35,250
0. 40 fte	12 hours per week	\$50,000	\$46,000	\$47,000
0. 50 fte	15 hours per week	\$62,500	\$57,500	\$58,750
0. 60 fte	18 hours per week	\$75,000	\$69,000	\$70,500
0. 70 fte	21 hours per week	\$87,500	\$80,500	\$82,250
0. 80 fte	24 hours per week	\$100,000	\$92,000	\$94,000
0. 90 fte	27 hours per week	\$112,500	\$103,500	\$105,750

Hourly Tutoring: With teaching certificate (HQ) \$14.60-\$32.54

If a private school would like to use a different wage, please contact GRPS to discuss.

TUTOR SALARY SCHEDULE

DESCRIPTION	RATE EFFECTIVE 2.1.2023	WITH EDUSTAFF 17%
Tutor/Aides with No Experience	\$12.48	\$14.60
Tutor/Aides with up to 2 years Experience	\$13.08	\$15.30
Tutor/Aides with extensive over 2 years Experience	\$13.68	\$16.00
Tutor with Bachelors Degree and No Experience	\$14.24	\$16.66
Tutor with Bachelors Degree and up to 2 years Experience	\$17.11	\$20.02
Tutor with Bachelors Degree and extensive over 2 years Experience	\$17.46	\$20.43
Tutor with Masters Degree and No Experience	\$17.82	\$20.85
Tutor with Masters Degree and up to 2 years Experience	\$19.95	\$23.34
Tutor with Masters Degree and extensive over 2 years Experience	\$21.37	\$25.00
Tutor with Certificate or License and No Experience	\$22.79	\$26.66
Tutor with Certificate or License and up to 2 years Experience	\$25.66	\$30.02
Tutor with Certificate or License and extensive over 2 years Experience	\$27.81	\$32.54
Teacher Instructional Position with Certificate or License	\$25.60	\$29.95

Due to contractual issues, EDUStaff tutors cannot exceed 25 hours per week.

2026-2027

TITLE I, PART A FEDERAL PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS PROGRAM/BUDGET APPROVAL FORM

PLEASE NOTE ALL INFORMATION IS SUBJECT TO BUDGET APPROVAL

Allocation: _____ Location: _____ ☐ **School Year** ☐ **Summer Program**

125 INSTRUCTION Added Needs (Direct Support for Students)

Describe how the **teacher** will serve the students (core content/SI Goals, intervention/support, leveled readers, etc.). Include Grade Levels and Connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment.

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Teacher Cost: \$ _____ (Average teacher salary and benefits is \$104.39 per hour)

125 INSTRUCTION Added Needs (Direct Support for Students)

Describe how the **tutor** will serve the students (core content/SI Goals, intervention/support, leveled readers, etc.). Include Grade Levels and Connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. **Please note all tutors must be Highly Qualified.**

Number of Tutors: _____ Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Tutor Cost: \$ _____ (Average tutor salary and benefits is \$34.00 per hour)

Supplies/Materials: \$ _____

Indicate the materials and supplies that will be ordered and how they connect to and support your student needs. Materials/supplies must be IN ADDITION to any district supported materials/supplies. Connect each item to Goals Management/Needs Assessment.

RETURN BY MAY 8, 2026

Please scan or email the completed form to Marissa Stoutjesdyk at stoutjesdykm@grps.org

Continued on next page

2026-2027

TITLE I, PART A FEDERAL PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS PROGRAM/BUDGET APPROVAL FORM

PLEASE NOTE ALL INFORMATION IS SUBJECT TO BUDGET APPROVAL

210 PUPIL SUPPORT SERVICES

Indicate additional FTE that your building will provide in addition to what the district provides, types of services being provided and connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. _____

Social Worker salary: _____ Social Worker benefits: _____ Retirement (40%*): _____ FICA (7.65%*): _____

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Social Worker Cost: \$ _____

210 PUPIL SUPPORT SERVICES

Indicate additional FTE that your building will provide in addition to what the district provides, types of services being provided and connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. _____

Counselor salary: _____ Counselor benefits: _____ Retirement (40%*): _____ FICA (7.65%*): _____

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Counselor Cost: \$ _____

330 COMMUNITY SERVICES

A series of parent nights will be planned to support the home-school connection and align to Goals Management. Include materials for parents to take home & refreshments.

Parent Night/Activities materials: \$ _____

Total Community Service Costs: \$ _____

Signature _____

Date _____

*Based on FTE benefits. May be adjusted.

RETURN BY MAY 8, 2026

TITLE I MATERIALS REQUEST PRE-AUTHORIZATION FORM – PRIVATE SCHOOLS

MUST SEND ALL TITLE I PURCHASE REQUEST TO:

Title I Office

Phone: 819-3276

Please scan or email the completed form to

Marissa Stoutjesdyk at stoutjesdykm@grps.org

***MUST BE COMPLETED FOR ALL SUPPLIES**

School: _____

Date Materials Needed: _____

Estimated Cost:

* _____ **Supplies:** Please list specific items and provide rationale for how the supplies are going to be used:

* _____ **Other:** Please specify: _____

Rationale-Core Academic Area: _____

SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL: _____ **DATE:** _____

DATE RECEIVED BY TITLE I: _____

RETURN WITH BUDGET SHEETS BY MAY 8, 2026

TITLE I PARENT EVENT REQUEST PRE-AUTHORIZATION FORM – PRIVATE SCHOOLS

MUST SEND ALL TITLE I PURCHASE REQUEST TO:

Title I Office
Phone: 819-3276
Please scan or email the completed form to
Marissa Stoutjesdyk at stoutjesdykm@grps.org

***MUST BE COMPLETED FOR ALL PARENT EVENTS PRIOR TO EVENT**

***INCLUDE AN AGENDA**

School: _____

Date of Activity and/or Date Materials Needed: _____

Estimated Cost:

* _____ **Supplies:** Please list specific items and provide rationale for how the supplies are going to be used:

* _____ **Food:** Vendor Name: _____

* _____ **Other:** Please specify: _____

***How many Title I parents do you anticipate attending the event?** _____

***How many Title I students do you anticipate attending the event?** _____

Description of the Activity/Materials: _____

Rationale-Core Academic Area: _____

SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL: _____ **DATE:** _____

DATE RECEIVED BY TITLE I: _____

RETURN WITH BUDGET SHEETS BY MAY 8, 2026

*****SURVEYS, AGENDAS AND SIGN IN SHEETS MUST BE COMPLETED AT EVERY TITLE I PARENT EVENT**

Parental involvement is a crucial factor of Title 1 legislation. Schools receiving Title 1 funding must implement programs, activities, and procedures that include and promote parent involvement in school-related activities. Schools must also provide opportunities that encourage parents to increase their knowledge and skills as they relate to their child's education. One of the objectives of these programs and activities is to help parents understand and show them how important their involvement is in shaping the lives of their children in becoming successful and productive contributors to our society.

2026-2027

TITLE IV, PART A FEDERAL PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS PROGRAM/BUDGET APPROVAL FORM

PLEASE NOTE ALL INFORMATION IS SUBJECT TO BUDGET APPROVAL

Allocation: _____ Location: _____ ☐ **School Year** ☐ **Summer Program**

125 INSTRUCTION Added Needs (Direct Support for Students)

Describe how the **teacher** will serve the students (core content/SI Goals, intervention/support, leveled readers, etc.). Include Grade Levels and Connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment.

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Teacher Cost: \$ _____ (Average teacher salary and benefits is \$104.39 per hour)

125 INSTRUCTION Added Needs (Direct Support for Students)

Describe how the **tutor** will serve the students (core content/SI Goals, intervention/support, leveled readers, etc.). Include Grade Levels and Connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. **Please note all tutors must be Highly Qualified.**

Number of Tutors: _____ Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Tutor Cost: \$ _____ (Average tutor salary and benefits is \$34.00 per hour)

Supplies/Materials: \$ _____

Indicate the materials and supplies that will be ordered and how they connect to and support your student needs. Materials/supplies must be IN ADDITION to any district supported materials/supplies. Connect each item to Goals Management/Needs Assessment.

RETURN BY MAY 8, 2026

Please scan or email the completed form to Marissa Stoutjesdyk at stoutjesdykm@grps.org

Continued on next page

2026-2027

TITLE IV, PART A FEDERAL PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS

PROGRAM/BUDGET APPROVAL FORM

PLEASE NOTE ALL INFORMATION IS SUBJECT TO BUDGET APPROVAL

210 PUPIL SUPPORT SERVICES

Indicate additional FTE that your building will provide in addition to what the district provides, types of services being provided and connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. _____

Social Worker salary: _____ Social Worker benefits: _____ Retirement (40%*): _____ FICA (7.65%*): _____

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Social Worker Cost: \$ _____

210 PUPIL SUPPORT SERVICES

Indicate additional FTE that your building will provide in addition to what the district provides, types of services being provided and connect to Goals Management/Needs Assessment. _____

Counselor salary: _____ Counselor benefits: _____ Retirement (40%*): _____ FICA (7.65%*): _____

Hours per day: _____ Days per week: _____ Total hours per week: _____

Start date: _____ End date: _____ Number of weeks: _____

Total Counselor Cost: \$ _____

*Based on FTE benefits. May be adjusted.

RETURN BY MAY 8, 2026

TITLE IV MATERIALS REQUEST PRE-AUTHORIZATION FORM – PRIVATE SCHOOLS

MUST SEND ALL TITLE I PURCHASE REQUEST TO:

Title I Office

Phone: 819-3276

Please scan or email the completed form to

Marissa Stoutjesdyk at stoutjesdykm@grps.org

***MUST BE COMPLETED FOR ALL SUPPLIES**

School: _____

Date Materials Needed: _____

Estimated Cost: _____

* _____ **Supplies:** Please list specific items and provide rationale for how the supplies are going to be used:

* _____ **Other:** Please specify: _____

Rationale-Core Academic Area: _____

SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL: _____ **DATE:** _____

DATE RECEIVED BY TITLE IV: _____

RETURN WITH BUDGET SHEETS BY MAY 8, 2026

Title IV funds must be supplemental and must meet one of the three major retirement strategies. Please see Examples of allowable use of funds on Page 40.

TITLE II

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

SUPPORTING EFFECTIVE INSTRUCTION

- 1. Improving the knowledge of teachers and principals in one or more of the core academic subjects as well as in effective instructional teaching strategies, methods, and skills**
- 2. Professional learning in effectively integrating technology into curricula and instruction**
- 3. Professional learning in how to teach students with different needs, including students with disabilities or ELs, and gifted and talented students**
- 4. Professional learning in methods of improving student behavior, identifying early and appropriate interventions, and involving parents more effectively in their children's education**
- 5. Leadership development and management training to improve the quality of principals and superintendents**
- 6. Professional learning in the use of data and assessments to improve instruction and student outcomes**

GENERAL QUESTIONS

- 1.** Does the professional development program have to be the same as the program for the public school teachers? No. If the professional development needs of the private school teachers are different from those of the public school teachers, the LEA and private school representatives should develop a separate program.
- 2.** May funds be used to pay stipends to private school teachers participating in a Title II, Part A professional development program? Yes, as reasonable and necessary. If the professional development activity is conducted after school hours or in the summer, stipends may be needed to compensate teachers for their participation outside their regular employment hours. Stipends must be paid directly to the private school teachers and not to the private school.
- 3.** May funds be used to pay any portion of a private school teacher's salary or benefits? No.
- 4.** May funds be used to pay for substitute teachers who replace teachers from private schools while they attend professional development activities? No, only the LEA.
- 5.** May professional development be conducted within private schools? Yes, activities may be conducted in the private school facilities.
- 6.** May professional development cover non-secular content? No, federal funds cannot be used for any religious content.

ALLOWABLE ACTIVITIES GUIDELINES

CONFERENCES

All conferences must be pre-approved by the GRPS Title II Program Office prior to registration. Any religious and/or out-of-state conferences must be approved by MDE prior to registering. **DO NOT REGISTER BEFORE RECEIVING APPROVAL.**

Eligible conferences must take place after July 1, 2026 and before the first day of school for GRPS in 2027 (which is generally 2 weeks before Labor Day)

MDE issued out-of-state conference forms must be submitted to GRPS with the original plan (or at amendment if adding) for pre-approval by MDE. Once you have received approval, please follow the steps below to register.

1. Where possible, please register yourself for the approved conference(s) and have the organizer provide an invoice payable to Grand Rapids Public School. Upload this invoice, with your reference number as the file name (e.g. CC-26-05 MACUL conference invoice ddmmyy) to your "Payment Request" folder as explained earlier and send an email notification to Titell@grps.org. **You will not need to complete a Payment Reimbursement form.**
2. If this option is not available, the individual attending the conference will need to pay this amount personally and submit for reimbursement (page 34-35). If approved, reimbursement can be submitted prior to the event occurring. You do not need to wait until the event has occurred to submit this reimbursement. *NOTE: No Title IIA funds can be paid directly to the Public School so don't use your District Funds for any Title spending.*
3. An individual requesting reimbursement must fill out a Payment Request Form (page 36) and include all original, itemized receipt.
 - **Hotels** – we require the final bill showing PAID IN FULL balance. We will not reimburse for MI Use Tax as we are tax-exempt and this should be noted with the hotel when making your reservation. We will not reimburse for suites, room upgrades or other incidentals.
 - **Meals** – We require the original receipts and will not reimburse for the purchase of alcoholic beverages. See more information below on what is needed to process.
 - **Travel** – details for all travel expenses incurred – see below Payment Reimbursement for more details on submitting
4. **Attendees must provide proof of attendance with a sign-in sheet and/or certificate of completion and submitted to Titell@grps.org within 10 business days of completion of the course.** This can include a name badge, certificate of completion or other conference materials that show your attendance.

PROFESSIONAL LEARNING MATERIALS

Professional learning materials must be connected to a professional development session school staff are attending. All professional development materials must be pre-approved by the GRPS Title II Program Office prior to an order being placed. **GRPS must place all material orders and will arrange delivery to the Private School.** Please be sure to provide any dates in your Plan when materials are required.

1. Once material items are approved by MDE, GRPS will update the Pre-Authorization form in the google drive.
2. Title II Program Office will submit all documentation to the GRPS Purchasing Office and order the materials.
3. The GRPS Purchasing Office will process the purchase requisition and order the materials.
4. If any problems arise with the ordering process, the GRPS Purchasing Office will work in conjunction with the GRPS Title II Program Office and the PS to make necessary corrections.
5. Shipments must be sent to GRPS.
6. Upon receipt of the items, GRPS will label the items as property of GRPS and will coordinate with the PS on delivery of the materials.

TRAINING COURSES

Eligible training must take place after July 1 and before the first day of school for GRPS in 2027 (which is generally 2 weeks before Labor Day)

1. A Pre-Authorization form needs to be submitted and approved for hiring a consultant service. A description of services provided, expected outcomes, resume of the consultant, and a signed contract must be included.
2. All consultant contracts must be approved by the Title IIA Program Office and signed by the Private School prior to services being provided.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT COURSES

Once you have your approved Pre-Authorization form please register and have the training company invoice GRPS.

Attendees will need to provide proof of attendance with a hand written sign-in sheet and/or certificate of completion. Invoices will be paid after the completion of the course. For online courses, an "Online Course Activity Log" must be included with the request for payment after the course is completed.

TITLE II PRIVATE SCHOOL GUIDELINES

Grand Rapids Public Schools (GRPS) has established the following guidelines concerning the spending of Title IIA grant funds by Private Schools (PS).

Each Private School is required to submit their Professional Development Plan (Page ##) by May 31st, 2026 for the upcoming 2026-2027 school year. Each activity on your plan must also have a Pre-Authorization form (Page ##) before any expenses will be approved.

GOOGLE DRIVE

GRPS has created an individual Google Drive for each private school that will allow one central location for sharing information and files. Please reach out to TitleII@grps.org if you need to add additional staff or you have any problems accessing your drive.

Each item in your Title IIA plan will be provided a unique reference number when the original budget/plan is submitted. Please preface all files with this reference for easy access when putting files into this drive. For ease of organization, each drive will then have the following sub folders:

Budget/Plan

- Upload your original plan here (School Name original Title IIA plan ddmmyy) - **View sample on page 31**
- GRPS will add the submitted plan to Nexsys (School Name original plan Nexsys ddmmyy)
- At amendment time, please provide your updated plan to include items spend all carryover and final allocation. ***NOTE: The plan must equal the total carryover and final allocation amount to the dollar (from your final allocation letter).***
- GRPS will add the amended plan to Nexsys (School Name amendment plan Nexsys ddmmyy)

Payment Request

- Upload all your reimbursement requests — please name the file with the item reference number and details of event (e.g. CC-27-05 MACUL conference registration 081526)
- Send original receipts with the reference number by mail to Title IIA office
1331 Martin Luther King Jr St Grand Rapids MI 49506
- When processed, we will rename the file with PAID

Pre-Authorization

- When you submit your original plan, please upload your pre-authorization form here (e.g. CC-27-05 PreAuth Form) **View sample on page 32.**
- When signed, we will swap out with the new copy and rename the file (e.g. CC-27-05 PreAuth Form signed)

Pre-Approval (non-secular/out-of-state ONLY)

- If you are attending a conference or training that has non-secular content or at a non-secular location, please complete the MDE form and upload here (e.g. CC-27-06 OOS Form)
- All out-of-state conferences will also need this form completed and uploaded, please use the same naming convention as above
- Email the Title II Program Office (titleii@grps.org)

TITLE II, PART A PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN EXAMPLE

Date: _____ School: _____ Principal/Administrator: _____

Phone: _____ Email: _____

REFERENCE NUMBER (ABBREVIATION-YEAR-ITEM NUMBER)	SPECIFIC EVENT/LOCATION/ DATE/ATTENDEES WITH DETAILED ROLES LIST	SPECIFIC GOALS AND TARGETED PARTICIPATION	RESEARCH-BASED STRATEGIES/ACTIVITIES/ RESOURCES TO ACHIEVE	LEARNING OUTCOME	COSTS
GRPS-27-01	MACUL Conference Date: March 6, 2026. Location: Grand Rapids, MI. Attendees: Five (5) certified teachers, one (1) principal, one (1) assistant principal.	All teachers will apply strategies using differentiated instruction to improve students' reading comprehension skills during 2026-27. Targeted Participation: Teachers in grades 1-5 will participate. Total: 15 Teachers and 2 Principals	Strategies: - Teachers will develop a variety of differentiated instructional strategies to address all students' learning needs. - Teachers will participate in a PLC. Activities: To assist in Reading fluency and comprehension, Teachers will be monitored as they implement Fresh Reads during weekly reading instruction. PD Needed: - Quality Read-a-louds - Shared Reading - PLC Contribution	Teachers will read to a group of students and allow students to appreciate print and interesting literature. Teachers participate in PLCs to examine instructional practices being implemented in the classroom around the use of differentiated instruction, including Read-a-louds.	Trainer: \$250 (\$83.34 x 3 hrs) Out-of-Contract-Hours Stipend: \$1,050 (7 staff x \$50/hr x 3hrs)

☐ APPROVED

GRPS TITLE II, PART A SUPERVISOR

Date

Blank Template located in Title II Google Drive or you can email Title II@grps.org

2026-2027 TITLE II, PART A FUNDING PRE-AUTHORIZATION FORM

THIS FORM MUST BE COMPLETED A MINIMUM OF 6 WEEKS PRIOR TO THE USE OF FUNDS OR BEFORE THE PROFESSIONAL LEARNING SESSION IS SCHEDULED.

Please send your request to: Professional Learning, Phone: 616-819-1997, Fax: 616-819-3480, Email: pd@grps.org

PRIVATE SCHOOL ADMINISTRATORS: Please complete the information requested below. Attach an agenda and additional information.

Contact Name

Phone Number

Email

Name of School

Location (City/State)

Date(s)

Description of Professional Development (Attach MDE required documentation)

Name(s) of staff requesting to attend with job title/role

☐ **IN-STATE** ☐ **OUT-OF-STATE** ☐ **NON-SECULAR**

SUPERINTENDENT/SCHOOL PRINCIPAL'S SIGNATURE

Date

TITLE II, PART A SUPERVISOR (GRPS)

Date

DATE RECEIVED BY ORGANIZATIONAL LEARNING: _____

☐ **APPROVED** ☐ **NOT APPROVED** Reason: _____

REFERENCE #: _____

ANTICIPATED EXPENSES: Refer to Technical Assistance Packet for guidance on reasonable conference expenses.

EXPENSE	COST
Consultation/Registration	\$
Lodging	\$
Transportation (Mileage, gas, cab, parking, etc)	\$
Meals	\$
Other Provide Description	\$
TOTAL	\$

2026-2027 TITLE II, PART A TRAVEL INFORMATION FORM

Please complete the following information needed to complete booking an airline flight and/or hotel room. If you have questions, please email Diane Liggins ligginss@grps.org. We will do our best to meet your preferences when available.

PERSONAL INFORMATION:

FULL LEGAL NAME (ON DRIVERS LICENSE):	
DATE OF BIRTH:	CELL PHONE#*:
EMAIL ADDRESS:	

TRAVEL PREFERENCES:

DEPARTING FROM:	ARRIVING TO:
ARRIVAL DATE AND TIME:	
DEPARTURE DATE AND TIME:	
SEAT ASSIGNMENT PREFERENCE (NOT GUARANTEED): ☐ WINDOW ☐ AISLE ☐ NO PREFERENCE	
ADDITIONAL DETAILS:	

*Cell phone numbers will only be used for airline updates

TITLE II

REIMBURSEMENT

GUIDELINES

Allowable Title IIa expenses can be reimbursed in one of two ways; (1) submit an invoice payable to GRPS from an approved vendor for payment through Accounts Payable via a Purchase Order; or (2) submit a Payment Request form for expenses incurred by staff.

All requests must be submitted within 60 days of the event (please add the date to the file when uploading Payment Requests/Purchase Order). Requests submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed. Please submit payment requests by uploading the required documentation in the Google Drive folder "Payment Requests" and email the Title II Program Office (TitleII@grps.org) notification. Please remember that your reimbursement requests are public records and what you submit can be subject to a FOIA request.

All expenditures on Title IIa activities must be conducted in accordance with GRPS Travel Guidelines and Reimbursement of Conference Meal Expenses – Out-of-Town Conference

CHECKLIST

We have provided a checklist for each activity in you plan to ensure you have all documentation. This form is for your records only.

PURCHASE ORDER

- Upload the Vendor invoice to the Google Drive with the following file name – ref vendor Invoice ddmmyy (e.g. ASE-27-05 Solution Tree Invoice 080526)
- Provide the vendor W9
- If you are requesting booking for out-of-state travel, please complete the Travel Information Form – Non-District Employees for each attendee

PAYMENT REQUEST

- Complete the Title II, Part A Payment Request form and upload to the Google Drive with the following file name – ref event ddmmyy (e.g. ASE-27-02 MACUL 082026)
- Mail original receipts with reference number
- *Ensure you have all the documentation needed
- Within 10 days of the event completion or attendance, please provide documentation confirming completion or attendance (eg. certificate of completion, conference badge or event sign-in sheets)

TITLE II, PART A REQUEST CHECKLIST

Before submitting your Title IIA request, please confirm that you have gathered and included all necessary information and documentation. **Check each box below to confirm that all required materials are prepared and attached.**

***PLEASE REMEMBER TO USE THE APPROPRIATE FORM FOR YOUR REQUEST, PRE-AUTHORIZATION OR PAYMENT REQUEST FORM.*

GENERAL INFORMATION

Event Name:

Reference #:

- ☐ I have selected the correct form for my request. ☐ I have entered in the school name and contact person
☐ Pre-authorization Request ☐ Payment Request

REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION

- ☐ I have completed and uploaded the appropriate **Title IIA Request Form(s)**

Section 1: Pre-authorization Request

- ☐ Pre-authorization PDF Form (fillable) ☐ Online/Embedded Pre-authorization Request Form
☐ Online PD Event ☐ Conference Documentation ☐ Travel Information Form

Section 2: Payment Request

- ☐ Online Professional Development Event Submission Form ☐ Receipts
☐ Payment Request GRPS Payment Request Form Request Form ☐ W9 Forms
☐ Fillable General Payment Request Form ☐ Mileage Documentation
☐ Online Professional Development Event Submission Form ☐ Invoices

ALIGNMENT & APPROVAL

- ☐ I have reviewed and confirmed that this request aligns with our school's PD plan.
☐ I have verified that this request complies with Title IIA guidelines and allowable activities.

CERTIFICATION

By signing this form, I certify that I have gathered and submitted all required documentation and information necessary to process this Title IIA request.

Signature

Date

TITLE II, PART A PAYMENT REQUEST



Request # _____ Requested By _____ Date _____

Requestor Name _____ Street Address _____ City/State/Zip _____

This payment is for: _____ Reference # _____

COMPLETE THIS BOX IF THIS IS A SERVICE PAYMENT	YES	NO	Vendor #
1. Attached is a written contract with the payee.	☐	☐	
2. A written contract with the payee is on file in the business office.	☐	☐	Gross Payment
3. I certify that an employer-employee relationship does not exist for this service.	☐	☐	

Payment Description	Separate Check (Y) ☐
	Return Check to School ☐

FUND	BDIR	AREA	FUNC	PRGM	SPRG	OBJECT	INITIALS	DATE
INVOICE/RECEIPT		DESCRIPTION			AMOUNT			
NUMBER	DATE							

Requested By _____ Date _____

Control Officer _____ Date _____

Business Office Approval _____	Date _____
--------------------------------	------------

**DO NOT WRITE IN SHADED AREAS * ALL RECEIPTS/ORIGINAL INVOICES MUST BE ATTACHED.
PAYMENT WILL NOT BE MADE FROM STATEMENTS, ACKNOWLEDGMENTS OR PACKING SLIPS**

TITLE II TRAVEL GUIDELINES

The Director of Purchasing processes all conference registrations, hotel reservations and all air travel arrangements for all Out-of-State travel.

TRAVEL

The procedure listed below provides a high-level overview of requirements in which all employees traveling with any funding source including general funds and grant funds, must comply:

BUDGET:

- All travel must be budgeted. The availability of funds for travel must be verified.
- If travel is not budgeted, **travel cannot be requested or authorized.**

APPROVAL/AUTHORIZATION PROCESS:

- Administrative Employees: must have approval from the appropriate district staff before travel arrangements are made.
- Teachers/School-Based Employee: must have approval from the Principal, Executive Director, Deputy Superintendent PK-12 Leadership & Learning and Superintendent before travel arrangements are made and/or travel commences for out-of-state travel. For in-state travel, approval is needed only from the Principal and Executive Director.
- Before any travel commences, include the conference agenda. All approvals must be received before any reservations or paying for registrations. **Note: The preference for Out-of-state travel request should be submitted for approval at least 90 days prior to the conference date.**
- Unauthorized travel lacking any or all required approval signatures will not be processed.

AIR TRAVEL:

Air travel arrangements are **NOT** made for in-state or Chicago vicinity travel.

CAR RENTALS:

Car rentals, if necessary, are to be made by the employee and turned in for reimbursement. The size of the vehicle should be based on the number of people being transported.

REQUIRE FORMS & DOCUMENTATION

In addition to the required approval signatures that must be submitted for any travel request, the preferred method is to process an ePurchase request and also contact the Director of Purchasing, Diane Liggins by emailing ligginss@grps.org to discuss upcoming travel requests.

The ePurchase request must contain the following attached information:

- Request for Approved Short Term Absence Form(s)
- The Official Conference Agenda contains information displaying location, registration, hotel, dates and cost
- Funding source (account number to be utilized to incur all associated costs)

QUESTIONS

Questions on Travel Guidelines can be directed to the Director of Purchasing at ligginss@grps.org.

REIMBURSEMENT OF MEAL EXPENSES

All requests must be submitted within 60 days of attending the conference. Requests submitted after 60 days will not be reimbursed. Please submit payment requests to the Title II Program Office. Please remember that your reimbursement requests are public records and what you submit can be subject to a FOIA request.

MEALS

Conference attendees are allotted an allowance for meals that are not provided during conference sessions. The meal allowance is based on the IRS per diem rate (<https://www.gsa.gov/>) for the specific location of the conference and it is calculated by meal, not as a single daily amount, and includes tips. Employees will be reimbursed for each meal based on the specific rates for the conference location rather than receiving one lump sum for the entire day's meal. There is no meal reimbursement for conferences in Grand Rapids. This applies to out-of-town conferences only.

Reimbursement is for meals not provided by the conference. For example: If the conference includes breakfast and lunch, the district will only reimburse for dinner. If a meal was provided during the conference session and the participant chooses to eat elsewhere, the meal will not be reimbursed.

Based upon conference schedule and drive time, reimbursement of meals is listed as follows.

DEPARTING FOR YOUR CONFERENCE

- Depart from home/office before 6:00 am: Breakfast allowed
- Depart from home/office before 12:00 pm (Noon): Lunch allowed
- Depart from home/office before 6:00 pm: Dinner allowed

ARRIVING FROM YOUR TRIP

- Arrive home/office before 12:00 pm (Noon): No lunch allowed
- Arrive home/office before 6:00 pm: No dinner allowed

When submitting a reimbursement request, the following must be listed:

- Conference Attended – Beginning and Ending Dates/Times
- Time of Departure on Day 1
- Meals which will be included / Meals which are not included for each day.
- **Itemized meal receipts are required** and must show date, location and items purchased.
- Arrival time on last day

SAMPLE PAYMENT REQUEST SUBMISSION LISTING

READING FIRST CONFERENCE

March 1st at 8:00 through March 3rd at 10:00

March 1st: Departed at 7:00 am

- Breakfast: Not reimbursable
- Lunch: Provided by conference
- Dinner: Burger King (receipt attached)

March 2nd

- Breakfast: Provided by conference
- Lunch: Provided by conference
- Dinner: Applebee's (receipt attached)

March 3rd: Arrive home/office at 11:00 am

- Breakfast: Provided by conference
- Lunch: Not reimbursable

QUESTIONS

Questions on Travel Guidelines can be directed to the Director of Purchasing at ligginss@grps.org.

TITLE III

ALLOWABLE PROGRAM EXPENDITURES

Title III services are for students that are identified as ELs. If students qualify for Title III, the following services can be provided:

- 1. ESL consultation**
- 2. ESL instructional materials**
- 3. Professional development through Grand Rapids Public Schools**
- 4. WIDA Screening and Access Trainings will be provided for each school with WIDA Administration. Each private school will identify a point person to administer the WIDA Assessment.**

Students become eligible for Title III services through a Home Language Survey and by taking the WIDA.

TITLE III

ALLOWABLE PROGRAM EXPENDITURES

Title III funds are supplemental and are to be used over and above the district's required services and resources provided to ELs and their families. **Required** activities include:

1. High quality language instruction educational programs that demonstrate effectiveness by increasing English proficiency and student academic achievement in the core academic subjects.
2. High quality professional development of sufficient intensity and duration that demonstrates effectiveness in improving instruction and assessment, enhances the ability of teachers to understand and use curricula, assessment measures, and instructional strategies **§3115(C)**

Title III supplemental EL funds can be used, in priority order, for the following:

1. Services during, before and after school such as tutoring, academic assistance, supplementary instructional materials for English language acquisition as well as for summer school programs for ELs. Districts need to identify the students served and the method used to assess and monitor their progress.
2. Professional development that is planned based on student achievement data and provided in a systemic and sustained manner to improve instruction and assessment of ELs. Staff training could include bilingual/ESL classroom teachers, bilingual/ESL teacher coaches, paraprofessionals, regular education teachers, administrators, and other school based or community-based organizational personnel who serve ELs.
3. Hiring bilingual/ESL coaches whose role is to acquire scientific-based research practices, provide professional development, mentor and coach teachers who are working directly with ELs. Additionally, such funds can be used to provide stipends to teachers to assist them in completing and obtaining bilingual/ESL endorsements.

4. Parent involvement activities including family literacy (ESL) and parenting classes. Additionally, funds can be used for speakers who conduct informative parent sessions that enhance student language acquisition and mastery of core academic subjects. Districts may purchase supplemental instructional materials to support child's English language learning at home, materials and books on parenting skills. A Parent Involvement Liaison can be hired or contracted to enhance ongoing parent engagement in school activities, committees and functions, facilitate planning and conducting parent meetings, connecting families to community resources, and interpreting to parents during Title III meetings.
5. Cost for educational field trips if part of high quality language instruction educational programs/activities (buses and admission).
6. Administrative and Indirect costs of III/Immigrant may NOT exceed 2% of the total allocation.

TITLE III NON- ALLOWABLE EXPENDITURES:

1. Title III funds may NOT be used to pick up a cost that was previously funded by general funds.
2. Title III may NOT supplant any other federal, state or local expenses.
3. All test administration cost (WIDA and WIDA Screener, other state assessments) must be paid by general fund, including the pay for proctors, assessors and substitute teachers.
4. Translation of documents, parent handbooks, and assessments are funded by general funds and NOT with Title III funds.
5. Title III funds may NOT be used for Intake/Eligibility or Annual progress assessments.

TITLE III MATERIALS REQUEST PRE-AUTHORIZATION FORM – PRIVATE SCHOOLS

MUST SEND ALL TITLE III PURCHASE REQUEST TO:

Title III Office
Phone: 616-819-2129
Please scan or email the completed form to
ATTN: Van Do at dov@grps.org and Erin Ruegg at ruegge@grps.org

***MUST BE COMPLETED FOR ALL SUPPLIES**

School: _____

Date Materials Needed: _____

Estimated Cost: _____

* _____ **Supplies:** Please list specific items and provide rationale for how the supplies are going to be used:

* _____ **Other:** Please specify: _____

Rationale-Core Academic Area: _____

SIGNATURE OF PRINCIPAL: _____ **DATE:** _____

DATE RECEIVED BY TITLE III: _____

RETURN WITH BUDGET SHEETS BY MAY 8, 2026

TITLE IV, PART A

THE STUDENT SUPPORT & ACADEMIC ENRICHMENT PROGRAM (SSAE)

The Every Student Succeeds Act (ESSA) established a new grant; Title IV, Part A- Student Support and Academic Enrichment (SSAE). The ESSA established this as a block grant; making many activities that were funded under the No Child Left Behind Act of 2001 (NCLB) allowable as options for districts under Title IV, Part A.

Title IV, Part A- SSAE supports three major strategies:

- **Strategy A:** Well-Rounded Educational Opportunities
- **Strategy B:** Safe and Healthy Students
- **Strategy C:** Effective Use of Technology

The Title IV, Part A, SSAE program provides SEAs, LEAs, and schools the flexibility to tailor investments based on the needs of their unique student populations. Where possible, the US Department of Education encourages coordination and integration of the SSAE program with activities authorized under other sections of the law, as well as other federal programs to improve outcomes for students.

The minimum allocation to any LEA is \$10,000. Any LEA receiving more than \$30,000 must use:

- At least 20 percent of funds for activities to support well-rounded educational opportunities (ESEA section 4107);
- At least 20 percent of funds for activities to support safe and healthy students (ESEA section 4108); and
- A portion of funds for activities to support effective use of technology (ESEA section 4109)
- No more than 15 percent of Title IV, Part A funds used to support effective use of technology can be spent on infrastructure (devices, equipment, software applications, platforms, digital instruction resources and/or other one-time IT purchases) [ESEA section 4109(b)]. This does not mean 15 percent of the entire Title IV, Part A allocation; the 15 percent limit is on the total amount budgeted for technology.

OVERVIEW OF EXAMPLES OF ALLOWABLE SSAE USES OF FUNDS*

WELL ROUNDED EDUCATIONAL OPPORTUNITIES (ESEA SECTION 4107)	SAFE & HEALTHY STUDENTS (ESEA SECTION 4108)	EFFECTIVE USE OF TECHNOLOGY (ESEA SECTION 4109)
• Improving access to foreign language instruction, arts, and music education • Supporting college and career counseling, including providing information on opportunities for financial aid through the early FAFSA • Providing programming to improve instruction and student engagement in science, technology, engineering and mathematics (STEM), including computer science, and increasing access to these subjects for underrepresented groups • Promoting access to accelerated learning opportunities including Advanced Placement (AP) and International Baccalaureate (IB) programs, dual or concurrent enrollment programs and early college high schools • Strengthening instruction in American history, civics, economics, geography, government education, and environmental education	• Promoting community and parent involvement in schools • Providing school-based mental health services and counseling • Promoting supportive school climates to reduce the use of exclusionary discipline and promoting supportive school discipline • Establishing or improving dropout prevention • Supporting re-entry programs and transition services for justice-involved youth • Implementing programs that support a healthy, active lifestyle (nutritional and physical education) • Implementing systems and practices to prevent bullying and harassment • Developing relationship building skills to help improve safety through the recognition and prevention of coercion, violence, or abuse • Establishing community partnerships	• Supporting high-quality professional development for educators, school leaders, and administrators to personalize learning and improve academic achievement • Building technological capacity and infrastructure • Carrying out innovative blended learning projects • Providing students in rural, remote, and under served areas with the resources to benefit from high-quality digital learning opportunities • Delivering specialized or rigorous academic courses and curricula using technology, including digital learning technologies and assistive technology

* Note: This table provides examples of allowable activities and is not an exhaustive list.

An LEA that receives at least \$30,000 in SSAE program funds must conduct a comprehensive needs assessment that includes, at a minimum, a focus on the three content areas.

Title IV funds must be supplemental and must meet one of the three major requirement strategies. Please see Examples of allowable use of funds list above.

21ST CENTURY COMMUNITY LEARNING CENTERS

The 21st Century program provides after-school services to children that include both academic and enrichment activities. Programming is held at the public school site. Current after school sites based upon previous year funding. New grant application may effect after school sites for the 2026-2027 school year. We are applying for new grant funding for the upcoming school year. Information will be forwarded upon approval.

- Alger Middle School
- Buchanan Elementary School
- Burton Elementary School
- Campus Elementary School
- Cesar E. Chavez Elementary School
- Dickinson Academy
- Gerald R. Ford Academic Center
- Harrison Park Academy
- Martin Luther King, Jr. Leadership Academy
- Westwood Middle School

2027-2028 TITLE I & TITLE II, PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS NEEDS ASSESSMENT

THIS SURVEY OUTLINES THE NEEDS ASSESSMENT PROCESS FOR TITLE I AND TITLE II.

This needs assessment survey should guide your thinking as you plan for the 2027-2028 school year. Consider the needs of your Title I and Title II eligible students when responding to the following questions. Your responses will be used to document your Title I or Title II planning process. Please submit the Needs Assessment with your Title II Plan.

1. School: _____

2. Identify the data resources you and your staff are using to determine student progress in learning by content area. Mark all that apply.

	Reading	Writing	Mathematics	Science	Social Studies
NWEA MAP	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
AimsWeb	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Fountas and Pinnell	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Development Reading Assessment (DRA)	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
DIBELS	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
PSAT	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
SAT	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Mid-term and/or final exams	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
End of unit assessments	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
Other	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐

Please specify and indicate content area(s):

3. Considering the data resources you are using to track student progress, identify strengths. Be sure to specify content area(s) and/or specific subgroups of students.

Continued on next page

2027-2028 TITLE I & TITLE II, PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS NEEDS ASSESSMENT

4. What are the data identifying as concerns or areas needing improvement? Be sure to identify content area(s) and/or specific subgroups of students.

5. Describe the specific data and criteria you are using to identify students for an intervention program. Be sure to identify grade level(s), content area and assessment tool(s) as you describe your school's process for identifying students.

Examples: Grade 3 students scoring in the bottom quartile (1-24 national percentile) on a reading standardized assessment as needing reading intervention. Or your NWEA MAP data may be indicating that a specific group of students in grade 6 are scoring in the RIT range of 171-180 in the areas of Operation and Algebraic Thinking and need additional math support in this area.

6. Describe the specific needs that your staff have related to changing instructional practice to better meet the needs of the students identified for Title I interventions. For Title II, describe how the PD will improve teacher instructional practice.

7. Identify the specific research-based, best practice strategies that your staff will be using to change their instruction to positively impact academic achievement for the Title I identified students.

Continued on next page

2027-2028 TITLE I & TITLE II, PRIVATE SCHOOL PROGRAMS NEEDS ASSESSMENT

8. Indicate the research-based strategies, activities, and/or resources that you identified in your Professional Development Plan to impact student achievement. Be specific if using a program or attending a PD.

9. Identify the specific intervention methods you will use with the identified Title I students.

10. Describe how you will measure the success of these intervention methods.

Be sure to address the following:

- A. Specific assessment indicators used to measure success
- B. The frequency in which they will be assessed
- C. The goal of the expected growth
- D. Teacher implementation of the learning

PARENT INVOLVEMENT VS. FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FAMILY INVOLVEMENT AND FAMILY ENGAGEMENT?

A school striving for **FAMILY INVOLVEMENT** leads with its mouth—identifying projects, needs, and goals and then **telling** caregivers how they can contribute.

A school striving for **FAMILY ENGAGEMENT** leads with its ears—listening to what caregivers think, dream, and worry about. The goal of family engagement is to **gain** partners.

Family engagement is a **FULL, EQUAL, and EQUITABLE** partnership among families, educators, and community partners to promote scholar's learning and development, from birth through college and career.

FULL, EQUAL & EQUITABLE means:

- Families, community partners, and educators **work together as allies** to promote children's learning and development.
- The goal is for **all scholars** to have high-quality learning opportunities and supports necessary to succeed.
- Families and educators bring **equally valuable knowledge** to the table.
- Caregivers **know** their children, culture, and community.
- Educators **know** curriculum and child development.
- Families are **empowered** to work with educators, public officials, and community partners to remove systemic and structural barriers that perpetuate inequities and injustice.

“When families engage in their children’s learning, everyone wins!” – Dr. Karen Mapp

SCHOLAR WINS	CAREGIVER WINS	TEACHER WINS	SCHOOL WINS	SCHOOL DISTRICT WINS
- Higher grades and test scores. - Better attendance and engagement. - More positive attitudes and behavior. - Greater sense of efficacy and self-esteem. - Higher graduation rates and college/post-secondary attendance.	- Stronger parent-child relationships. - Better rapport with teachers and school staff. - Greater understanding of child's progress and how to help. - More knowledge and skill in advocating for child - Increased supportive social connections.	- Increased multicultural awareness and appreciation. - Greater success motivating and engaging students of diverse backgrounds. - More support from families. - Stronger morale and professional satisfaction.	- More positive school climate. - Higher morale and greater retention of teachers. - Improved facilities, better curriculum, and higher-quality programs. - More responsive to community concerns. - Better reputation and more support from the community.	- Reduced suspensions and high-risk behaviors. - Increased family and youth involvement in site-based decision. - Expanded mental and physical health resources leading to improved health. - High levels of participation in afterschool programs. - Increased high school rate.

TITLE I PARENT ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

FAMILY WORKING TOGETHER

Parents can work together with their schools by assisting with:

1. Writing or revising the Title I plan
2. Developing the Parent Compact
 - Developing high standards for all students by volunteering to participate on a curriculum committee.
 - School planning by representing parents on the School Improvement Team, either at the school or district level.

CAREGIVER ENGAGEMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Caregivers can involve themselves in their schools by:

1. Joining the school's parent organization (PTCC, etc.)
2. Attending workshops (Parent University) parents.grps.org
3. Volunteering (i.e. field trips, recess support, lunchroom support)
4. Tutoring
5. Attending open houses and parent teacher conferences.
6. Communicating with teachers, counselors, and the health team to discuss their child.
7. Attending board meetings.
8. Staying abreast of district communications via newsletters, emails, robocalls, and social media.
9. Partnering with school personnel to support their child's academic success.
10. Leading or participating in specialized groups school that promote specific short term projects (Beautification of school grounds, fund raisers, chaperon for different events, etc.)
11. Seeking service organizations and local merchants to join in a

school-to-work program if offered by the schools

PARENT-STAFF ENGAGEMENT ACTIVITIES

Parents and staff can work together to:

1. Start inviting parents of preschoolers to each program you schedule
2. Welcome parents to classroom events.
3. Schedule meetings at convenient times

FAMILY & COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT

“We have 50 years of research showing that what families do matters. Whether it’s loving school, college access, good attendance, or academic success, family engagement has positive correlations with all sorts of indicators.”

– Dr. Karen Mapp

THE IMPORTANCE OF FAMILY ENGAGEMENT

- Increased family engagement in schools is strongly associated with:
- Increased rates of literacy acquisition among children.
- Increased rates of going on to secondary education among youth.
- Increased attendance rates among students.
- Decreased rates of school dropout among youth.
- Increased positive health behaviors.

TYPES OF PARENT INVOLVEMENT

- **Parenting:** Support the home environment and strengthen families so as to support students at school.
- **Communicating:** Create effective modes of school-to-home and home-to-school communications regarding school programs and child progress.
- **Volunteering:** Recruit parents to support school endeavors.
- **Learning at Home:** Share information regarding ideas for learning at home, as well what is going on in the classroom to support family-school alignment regarding educational endeavors.
- **Decision Making:** Empower parents to be leaders, and involve them in school decision-making.
- **Collaborating with Community:** Identify and integrate resources and services from the community to strengthen school programs, family practices, and student learning and development.

ENGAGEMENT ESSENTIALS

- Offer flexible number of meetings at times convenient to caregivers and provide transportation, childcare, or home visits as it relates to parent involvement.
- Offer multiple sessions or record one version and share link.
- Deliver or offer school bus delivery for materials or hotspot.
- Utilize virtual meetings at flexible times (morning, day, evening) to connect with parents.
- Ensure regular two-way, meaningful communication between family members and school staff.

RELATIONSHIPS ARE KEY

- Offer getting-to-know-you meetings in smaller, informal settings.
- Make relationship-building home visits.
- Co-design programs alongside families.
- Create welcoming spaces in the program and schools.
- Learn the names of all families.
- Recognize scholar achievement.
- Develop parent advisory committees.

ENGAGEMENT EFFORTS ARE PURPOSEFUL AND INTENTIONAL

- **Linked to learning:** initiatives must be aligned with school and district achievement goals and connect parents to the teaching and learning goals for the students.
- **Relational:** a major focus of the initiative is on building respectful and trusting relationships between families and district, school and program staff.
- **Developmental:** the initiatives focus not only on providing a service but also on building the intellectual, social, and human capital of stakeholders engaged in the program.
- **Collective/Collaborative:** learning is conducted in group versus individual settings and focused on building strong networks and learning communities.
- **Interactive:** participants are given opportunities to test out, practice, and apply new skills.

FAMILY ENGAGEMENT EFFORTS ARE TAILORED TO ADDRESS ALL FAMILIES.

- Talk about the skills that will help children upon their transition to kindergarten and discuss children's progress with families regularly.
- Explain your school or program's high achievement goals and ask families about their ideas to help their kids reach them.
- Seek barriers and remove them.
- Provide opportunities for parent and student input on Title I school-parent compacts to make them more personalized.
- Respond to what students say about social and emotional issues.
- Set up an advisory system, so that all students have someone who knows them well and who can be their advocate.



www.michigan.gov/mde/0,4615,7-140-5233---,00.html

“The way schools care about children is reflected in the way schools care about the children’s families. If educators view children simply as students, they are likely to see the family as separate from the school. That is, the family is expected to do its job and leave the education of children to the schools. If educators view students as children, they are likely to see both the family and the community as partners with the school in children’s education and development.”

– Joyce Epstein

INDIVIDUALS WITH DISABILITIES EDUCATION ACT (IDEA)

Per the U.S. Department of Education, Provisions Related to Children with Disabilities Enrolled by their Parents in Private Schools, IDEA is designed to improve educational results for all children with disabilities. Therefore, it provides benefits and services to children with disabilities in public schools and requires school districts to make services and benefits available to children with disabilities enrolled by their parents in nonpublic schools.

The LEA's obligations to parentally placed private school children with disabilities are different from its responsibilities to those enrolled in public schools or to children with disabilities placed in a private school by a public agency (rather than by parents) as a means of providing FAPE.

It is important to note that parentally placed children with disabilities do not have an individual entitlement to services they would receive if they were enrolled in a public school. Instead, the LEA is required to spend a proportionate amount of IDEA federal funds to provide equitable services to this group of children. Therefore, it is possible that some parentally placed children with disabilities will not receive any services while others will. For those who receive services, the amount and type of services also may differ from the services the child would receive if placed in a public school by the parents or in a private school by a public agency.

CHILD FIND - §300.131

The LEA where private schools are located (district of location) is responsible for locating, identifying, and evaluating all children with disabilities who are enrolled by their parents in private, including religious, and elementary schools. The LEA, in conducting child find for parentally-placed private school children with disabilities, must undertake activities similar to activities undertaken for the District of Location's public school children.

To access Child Find supports within Grand Rapids Public Schools please use contact us directly at childfind@grps.org or 616-819-3514.

A request for evaluation from a non-public school will filter into the GRPS Special Education Office through the following groups:

1. Early Childhood Non-Public Preschools for family residence in GRPS District (Ages 3-4).

- For ages 3-4 **stop here** and refer to the [Child Find Reminders for Preschool Aged Children](#)

2. Kindergarten through 12th Grade

- The non-public school notifies the designated GRPS Teacher Consultant of a request to evaluate.
- The teacher consultant forwards the intake form to the designated Special Education Secretary and helps to coordinate next steps including coordinating an evaluation team if determined necessary.

